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AQR Arbitrage

Greenwich, CT

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the 2027 Research Summer Analyst position at AQR Arbitrage. I am currently pursuing a master's degree in Data Science at Columbia University, where I also serve as a Graduate Teaching Assistant. Combined with my background in management consulting, business operations, and analytics, these experiences have shaped my interest in understanding the drivers behind business outcomes and using evidence to guide decisions. I am eager to bring that approach to investment research.

Most recently, at Shopee, I focused on the growth of a paid seller support program, where sellers paid for dedicated support to improve their performance on the platform. I managed a team of 10 BPO managers supporting the program while also owning marketing campaigns and revenue forecasting. My role was to understand what was driving seller adoption and performance, identify opportunities to grow the program, and translate those insights into campaigns and operating plans. That meant working across the full cycle: analyzing seller and sales data, forecasting revenue, deciding where to focus our marketing efforts, and coordinating with the BPO team to execute those initiatives. Through this work, I helped the program generate more than \$100,000 in annual recurring revenue and achieve 25% year-over-year growth. The experience strengthened my ability to take ownership from analysis through execution while balancing growth targets with the practical realities of managing a team and operating a program day to day.

My broader career has also allowed me to approach these challenges from different perspectives. In operating roles, I learned how decisions translate into execution and measurable outcomes. At BCG, I gained experience approaching larger, more ambiguous strategic questions and structuring them through rigorous analysis. Now, through my master's in Data Science at Columbia, I am building a deeper technical foundation to complement those experiences. Together, this background has shaped how I approach problems: understanding the business context, using data to develop a clear direction, and staying close enough to execution to ensure that direction actually works.

AQR Arbitrage particularly appeals to me because of its commitment to rigorous research and the practical application of financial theory to arbitrage and corporate event strategies. I believe my combination of analytical experience, business judgment, and Python skills would allow me to contribute effectively to the team's work constructing datasets, testing investment hypotheses, and developing tools to support portfolio management. I would welcome the opportunity to learn from AQR Arbitrage's research and portfolio management team and discuss how my background and approach could contribute.

Sincerely,

Morgan Le